

Empathy Map

CrediShield AI — Credit Card Approval Prediction System

Target User Persona

Attribute	Details
Name	Priya Sharma
Role	Junior Credit Analyst at a mid-size NBFC
Age	26 years
Experience	2 years in credit operations
Location	Hyderabad, India
Education	B.Com with MBA in Finance
Daily Workload	Reviews 20–30 credit applications per day
Tools Used	Excel, Calculator, Paper files, Email

Empathy Map Canvas

👁 SEES (What does Priya observe in her environment?)

- Piles of pending credit card application files on her desk every morning
- Excel spreadsheets with hundreds of rows of applicant data
- Colleagues manually cross-referencing payment histories with credit bureau reports
- Monthly rejection-rate reports posted on the office notice board by management
- Newspaper articles and LinkedIn posts about banks adopting AI for lending decisions
- Senior analysts spending 30+ minutes on each borderline application
- Customers waiting in the branch lobby to check their application status
- Dashboard screens in the office showing pending application counts climbing daily

👂 HEARS (What does Priya hear from others?)

- **From her manager:** "We need to process applications faster — the backlog is growing."
- **From colleagues:** "I'm not sure about this applicant. Can someone double-check?"
- **From the news:** "Top banks are using AI to approve credit cards in under 60 seconds."
- **From HR:** "There's a new training session on RBI's updated lending guidelines next week."
- **From customers:** "It's been 2 weeks since I applied. What's taking so long?"
- **From senior analysts:** "Trust your instincts, but always check the debt-to-income ratio."
- **From the IT team:** "We're planning to digitize the application process by next quarter."
- **From industry conferences:** "Machine learning can predict default risk with 95%+ accuracy."

💭 THINKS & FEELS (What goes on in Priya's mind?)

Thoughts:

- "I wish I had a tool that could instantly tell me if this applicant is risky or safe."
- "Am I being too lenient? What if this person defaults and I get blamed?"
- "Am I being too strict? What if I'm rejecting genuinely good applicants?"
- "There has to be a more scientific way to do this than just gut feeling."
- "My senior approved someone similar last week — but rejected this one. What's the logic?"

Feelings:

- 😟 **Worried** about making wrong approval decisions that lead to defaults (NPAs)
- 😡 **Frustrated** by repetitive, manual data entry and cross-referencing work
- 🌱 **Hopeful** about upskilling in data analytics and ML to advance her career
- 😰 **Anxious** about meeting daily processing quotas set by management
- 😐 **Indifferent** about the outdated tools she's forced to use

🗣 SAYS & DOES (What are Priya's observable actions?)

Says:

- "Can someone double-check this application? I'm not confident about the risk level."
- "I've processed 15 applications today, but I still have 12 more in the queue."
- "The income looks fine, but the employment history is concerning."
- "I wish we had a scoring system instead of relying on judgment calls."
- "Let me ask the senior analyst before I approve this borderline case."

Does:

- Manually calculates debt-to-income ratios using a desk calculator
- Copies data from handwritten application forms into Excel spreadsheets
- Cross-references credit bureau reports with application details
- Asks senior analysts for guidance on borderline/ambiguous cases
- Stays late 2–3 days per week to clear the application backlog
- Maintains a personal Excel tracker of her daily approvals/rejections
- Attends monthly training sessions on new compliance regulations

🤔 PAIN POINTS (What frustrates Priya?)

#	Pain Point	Severity
1	No standardized scoring system — decisions rely on experience and gut feeling	● Critical
2	30+ minutes per application on manual verification and cross-referencing	● Critical
3	Inconsistent criteria — different analysts approve/reject identical profiles differently	● High
4	High-risk applicants slip through during peak workload periods due to analyst fatigue	● High
5	Gets blamed when approved clients subsequently default on payments	● High
6	No visual dashboard to track daily/weekly approval trends and team performance	● Medium
7	Paper-based reports that are difficult to search and analyze retrospectively	● Medium
8	No career growth path without learning modern tools like ML and analytics	● Medium

🎯 GAINS (What would make Priya's life better?)

#	Desired Gain	How CrediShield AI Addresses It
1	Instant approve/reject recommendation for each application	Sub-second ML prediction via the web dashboard
2	Confidence scores that quantify risk numerically	Animated SVG gauge showing 0–100% confidence
3	Risk grades (Low/Medium/High) for quick categorization	Automated classification based on probability thresholds
4	Printable assessment reports for compliance and audit records	PDF "Credit Assessment Letter" generation with full details
5	Visual analytics showing team performance and portfolio trends	Chart.js dashboards (feature importance, approval ratios, demographics)
6	Consistent, unbiased decisions across all applications	Same trained model applied to every applicant identically
7	More time for complex cases that genuinely need human expert judgment	AI handles obvious cases; analyst focuses on borderline ones
8	Career advancement through exposure to modern ML-powered tools	Working with an AI system builds Priya's data literacy

Key Insight

Priya doesn't need the AI to **replace** her — she needs it to **handle the obvious cases instantly** so she can focus her expertise on the borderline ones. The system must be **trustworthy** (showing confidence scores), **explainable** (showing risk levels and feature importance), and **fast** (sub-second predictions).

How CrediShield AI Addresses Each Quadrant

Empathy Quadrant	CrediShield AI Response
SEES (piles of applications)	Digital form replaces paper; instant results
HEARS ("process faster")	Sub-second predictions; no backlogs
THINKS ("is this risky?")	Confidence % and risk grade answer this objectively
SAYS ("double-check this")	AI provides the "second opinion" consistently
PAINS (30 min per app)	Reduces to 2 minutes (data entry + instant result)
GAINS (career growth)	Priya learns to work with ML-powered decision support

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